

RAKESH BARUAH

PLAYWRIGHT | SCREENWRITER | DIRECTOR

Milwaukee, Wisconsin
rakesh@rakeshbaruah.com
rakeshbaruah.com

PROFILE

Assamese American writer and director working across theatre, film, television, and fiction. His work explores power, identity, ambition, family, and the systems that shape private lives, often through heightened or genre-bending forms.

SELECTED THEATRE

Madam Pascal

Two-act rock musical | Book, libretto, and co-creator | 2016 to present

Created with composer and lyricist Marcus Ricci. Earlier versions received developmental readings and staged presentations at the Nuyorican Poets Cafe and Dixon Place in New York, including an Actors' Equity showcase in 2018. The complete score has been recorded as a studio concept album. The musical has not yet received a full professional production.

Tyrant

Full-length stage play | Playwright | In development

Joshua

Original musical | Writer | In development

The Lobby

One-act play | Playwright | In development

Double Bind: Palestine

One-act dark comedy | Playwright | In development

PERFORMANCE AND TRAINING

The Birdz and Beez | Writer and performer | Magnet Theater, New York | 2014

Seven-minute solo piece featuring two brothers offering opposing perspectives to their youngest brother.

Solo Storytelling Performance | Magnet Studio Theater, New York | 2014

Performed an original eight-minute story following study with Adam Wade.

Completed improvisation training at Magnet Theater and Upright Citizens Brigade in New York.

SELECTED SCREENWRITING RECOGNITION

The Little Ones | Teleplay | Quarterfinalist, Final Draft Big Break Competition

Sugar Baby | Short screenplay | Finalist, Slamdance Screenwriting Competition

ADDITIONAL SCREEN AND PROSE WORK

Rookies, novel, teleplay, and screenplay | Black Forest Drive, novel and screenplay | Desi, novel and screenplay | Sever, screenplay | Goodnight Nobody, screenplay in development

Short fiction includes What the Earth Holds, Field Notes, The Standard Model of Love, and Medium, Medium Rare.

MEDIA AND PUBLISHING EXPERIENCE

Professional experience includes work with Comedy Central, The Daily Show with Jon Stewart, The Colbert Report, Showtime Networks, BET, Blue Bloods, and Levinson/Fontana.

Apress / Springer | Author | 2018 to 2020

Author of two internationally published technical books on virtual reality, augmented reality, WebXR, C#, and JavaScript.

EDUCATION

Columbia University

Master of Fine Arts, 2016

Northwestern University

Bachelor of Arts, 2005